

Navi Mumbai Municipal Corporation's (NMMC)

initiative for NMMC School Girls on

"Safe, Shy-free & Healthy Menstruation" Practises"

Executed by



Lets talk about it...



March - Sept. 2016

- * 24 NMMC Schools
 - * 3000 plus girls touched
 - * 100 plus teachers volunteered
 - * 8 Ward Offices
 - * 350 plus female officers
- Great contribution by
NAVI MUMBAI MUNICIPAL
CORPORATION



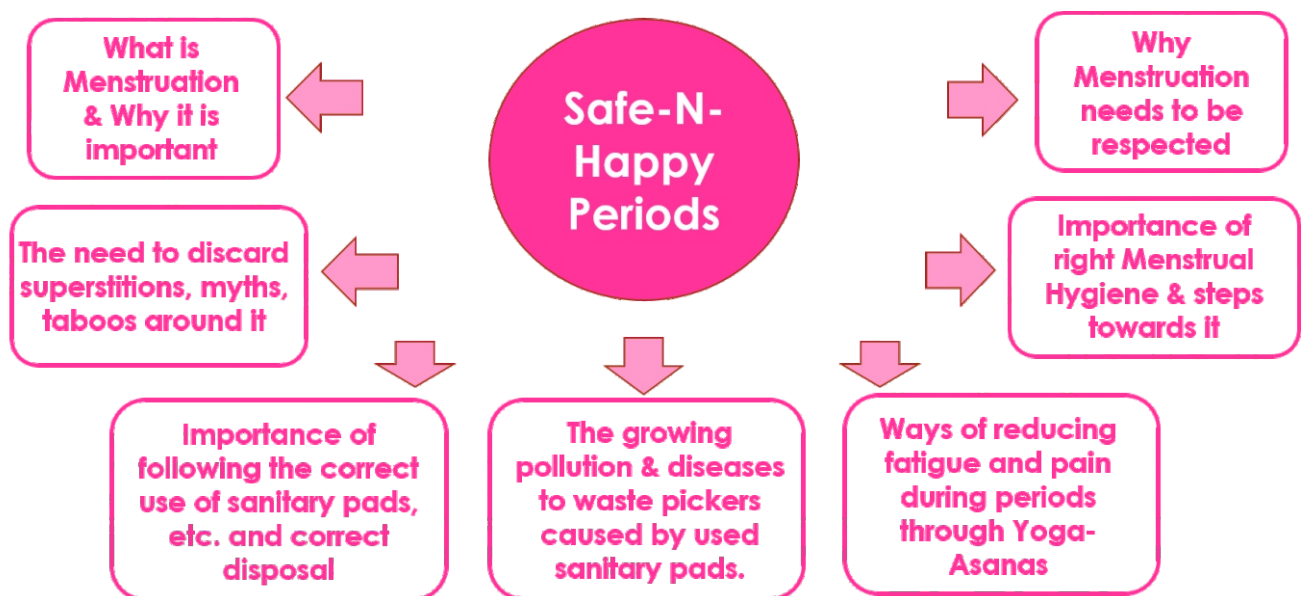
**REPORT on Workshops done
by "Safe-N-Happy Periods"
for NMMC School Girls &
Female Employees of
NMMC Ward Offices**

**Submitted In
September 2016**

Safe-N-Happy Periods (SNHP) is a humble step to create shy-free, pain-free, healthy, happy & sustainable menstruation time. The current environment presents challenges to young girls and we believe that spreading awareness through lectures, open discussions, and workshops will help create a healthier lifestyle for the girls and society.

Navi Mumbai Municipal Corporation (NMMC) gave SNHP a wonderful opportunity to deliver workshops for adolescent girls of their NMMC Schools all over Navi Mumbai area. The workshop was titled as **“Shy-free, Pain-free, Safe, Healthy & Happy Menstruation time”**. And the aim was to create awareness on different aspects of Menstruation. The small team of SNHP visited 24 schools and interacted with girls from the age group of 10-16 years together with female staff & teachers. We conducted the similar workshops for all the 8 Ward Offices and NMMC Head Office.

Our focus during the workshops at School:



JOURNEY WITH THE SCHOOLS

It was a learning experience not just for the school girls but also for us. It made us reach one step closer to the glaring reality which is looking right into our faces today. A reality which is unpleasant, painful, sad and rampant across our society. We all know about it in bits and pieces but owing to our cultural and social backdrop, it is seldom discussed. The more we interacted with people the more we were surprised that the urban situation is not significantly different then the rural one.

1) Biggest problem area is the silence around this topic. Girls are very uncomfortable & shy to talk about it. We are now more and more convinced that talking about **MENSTRUATION**, with a sense of urgency and respect, can bring about a change in the present sad state.

2) The collective feedback (both verbal and written) by the girls & teachers had many things in common, like:

a) Appreciation for our effort towards bringing awareness on Menstruation, which is taken as shame, TABOO and something filthy, even today.

b) Recognition of the urgent need of holding such programs in schools as kids find it much easier to talk to outside agencies then their parents or teachers.

3) It was both strange and heartening to hear teachers saying that they learnt so many new things about Periods, though they have been menstruating for years.

14% girls suffer from menstrual infection of some kind. (Wateraid)

66% girls do not know anything about Periods before MENARCHE (their first period (Unicef MHM)

70% of mothers consider Menses polluting and pass on the same bias to their daughters – (Earth& US)



87% girls do not know the importance of Menstruation or the biological process behind it. (Unicef MHM)



OBSERVATIONS CONTD.....

- 4) In many schools, there is huge absenteeism during period days, which is generally enforced by mothers asking girls to stay at home for almost 7-10 days sometimes.
- 5) The girls are not aware of right practices because their mothers are mostly uneducated and unaware themselves. Mostly they pass on the TABOOS, MYTHS, wrong information and a feeling of being dirty to their daughters.
- 6) Because of the socio-economic background of girls, their parents are mostly out of the house whole day. In case a girl gets her period, there is no one to guide her, especially when it's her first period. In such situations, if she is well equipped with right information, she can handle her MENARCHE (First Period) so much better.
- 7) All the GIRLS TOILET had a similar problem of littered soiled pads left in open. Carelessness, less awareness of knowing the impact and having no proper guidelines on the disposal of pads is leading to more problems.
- 8) They were less hesitant towards the end of workshop and asked us lots of questions which they always wanted to ask.

Your Valuable Feedback

safe'n' happyperiods
LET'S TALK ABOUT IT

Date: 16/03/2016

Name: Shabha K. Kudale

Age: 32

Profession: Principal (H.M.)

Designation: Principal

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Any Suggestions: pl. arrange like this (today) program next year onwards 4 in month of July. Arget Shubha

मुख्याध्यापक

नवी मुंबई महानगरपालिका, संविधान
माध्यमिक विद्यालय, तानपाडा, नवी मुंबई

FEEDBACK FORM

safe'n' happyperiods
LET'S TALK ABOUT IT

नाम : श्री. शबनी ललिता कोरवार

उम्र : 34

व्यवसाय : नोकरी

पद : मुख्याध्यापिका

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आपको वर्कशॉप कैसा लगा : आज हमारे स्कूल में safe'n' happy periods के बारे में बहुत सी बे आ बेकरींग किया वह बहुत ही अच्छा हुआ। छात्रियों को बहुत पसंद आया। छात्रियों की मन में छविए की वह हम लगी और महान की छात्रों में बेकरींग आयी।

आपके सुझाव : अगर ये बेकरींग फेलादी की सुझाव है (16.7.2016) में जानकी मिलेगी, तो जहाँ अच्छा रहेगी।

स्थान : छात्राशाली दिनांक : 20/3/16 हस्ताक्षर : [Signature]

safe'n' happyperiods
LET'S TALK ABOUT IT

A workshop by "SAFE-N-HAPPY PERIODS", on behalf of NMMC was held today 02/03/16 at N.M.H.C. School No. 29 Juhu Road.

The title of the workshop was "SAFE AND HEALTHY MENSTRUATION PRACTICES" and was conducted by Ms SARIKA GUPTA.

Participating School Teacher: 4 Signature: [Signature]

Date: 12/03/2016

Sarika Gupta
Founder & Facilitator
Safe-N-Happy Periods

This workshop is very useful for school going girls. I really impress through this workshop. Thank you mam.



OUR SUGGESTIONS BASED ON THE EXPERIENCE & FEEDBACK AT THE SCHOOL

1) The workshop, when done on a regular basis (twice a year or at least Annually for all girls between Class 5 to Class 12, will help the girls to implement healthy menstrual practices in their day-to-day life told to them).

2) Every year the girls of Class 4 upgrade to Class 5 and they have no idea about Periods. This is **THE TIME** to tell them about it all so that they can inculcate the right practices from the beginning.

3) With the given infrastructure (room size) in schools, we could only attend to few girls in one session while others were left out. We feel if we can conduct 2 sessions (Class 5th to 8th and Class 9 to 12th) we will be able to interact with all girls and teachers.

5) Once we have delivered the workshop, women teachers are with the girls all the time. We feel that if the women staff attend

this workshop they can pass on this information as and when required.

Subsequently there can be a feedback session where the teachers can interact with the girls.

6) If there can be a separate dustbin for throwing used pads, cloth (menstrual waste), it will isolate the waste in the bathroom itself. Right now all the school face a similar problem in the **GIRLS BATHROOM** of soiled used pads thrown open in the toilets. Which spreads germs, toxins and diseases.

7) Posters inside the girls bathroom about the correct usage and disposal of menstrual waste. This can be in Hindi Marathi or English, depending on the school.

A well informed Girl child will surely and confidently speak to her mother, sisters, friends about correct menstrual hygiene practices and spread the awareness further.



OUR EXPERIENCE, FEEDBACK GIVEN & SUGGESTIONS BASED ON INTERACTION WITH THE FEMALE EMPLOYEES AT NMMC WARD OFFICES

Our focus at Ward Office was a bit different while interacting with female staff. The age group varied from 24 to 60 plus years. Our workshops retained the same theme, but included **PRE-MENOPAUSE** & **MENOPAUSE** as well.

Some of the issues like lack of supportive infrastructure in bathrooms, dirty used pads littered in bathrooms and lack of awareness were common in almost all of the offices.

Out of their feedback and our discussion these things came out very clear:

1) They will be happy to have a separate dustbin for menstrual waste inside their toilets.

2) The need of having pamphlets inside the

bathrooms, which educates and re-enforces the need of correct disposal of pads.

3) Almost all the females appreciated the effort of NMMC in arranging this workshop. It was a nice opportunity for them to raise their concerns and ask questions, specially on the pain management, as over a period of time, women accept menstrual pain as a part of their lives.

So when we taught them few Yog-Asanas to relieve pain and discomfort they were very enthusiastic and happy.

They were very keen on having more of Asanas and discussion about the safe disposal of pads.



OUR THANKS TO

Our deepest gratitude to NMMC for recognizing the need and taking this wonderful initiative to GIRLS who were really in need of this.

Our sincere Thanks to:

- Mr. Tukaram Munde, Commissioner, NMMC
- Ankush Chavan Mr. Ankush Chavan, Addl. Commissioner (City), NMMC
- Smt. Trupti Sandbhor, DMC - Licence, Social Development & Slum Rehabilitation
- Mrs. Sandhya Ambade, AMC (Schemes)

- All the Ward Coordinators who made it possible for us to deliver the workshops with ease.

- All NMMC School Principals for their administration support

** All NMMC School girls, Teachers, Principals and women participants from the NMMC WARD offices who encouraged and appreciated our work

- AEGIS SCHOOL OF BUSINESS & DATA SCIENCE for their IT and Admin support.

Submitted By
Sarika Gupta
Founder & Facilitator
Safe-N-Happy Periods

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